

Statistics

The tables in this section differ from those in other chapters because of the uniqueness of this chart pattern. Many of the statistics provided elsewhere do not apply because there is no breakout and no ultimate low or high. Success is measured by how often the second leg meets or exceeds the length of the first leg.

[Table 47.2](#) shows general statistics for measured moves.

Number found. Measured moves are as plentiful as ants near spilled sugar, except when you need a good example for a book you're writing. I found 1,338 patterns in 870 stocks from January 1991 to December 2014, but not all stocks covered the entire range. Some no longer trade, too.

Average length. Measured moves have no time limit (if it's less than 3 weeks from leg to leg, it might be better classified as a flag or pennant).

[Table 47.2](#) General Statistics

Description	Bull Market	Bear Market
Number found	1,038	300
Average length (days)	99	69
Median first leg rise	26% in 21 days	31% in 18 days
Median corrective phase retrace	47% in 19 days	48% in 15 days
Median last leg rise	24% in 20 days	27% in 17 days

The average length is about 2 to 3 months, depending on market conditions. Bear markets have price that moves faster than bull markets, so maybe that accounts for the shorter duration.

Performance. The Results Snapshot shows the *average* behavior of measured moves, so I'm showing the *median* move in the table.

Let's compare the bull market move of the first and second legs. Price rises 26% in the first leg in 21 days and nearly the same amount in the second leg. It appears that the two legs are nearly the same size, both in price and time. The Results Snapshot averages show it's not as clear as that, and it gets worse if you translate the percentage moves into dollar moves. What